

Best Ball Butts 2026: Week 3 outlook

As of 2026-09-24. Weeks 1–2 are final and locked in; Week 3 starts tonight. The numbers are the average of 12 season simulations (6 projection sources × 2 noise models, 8,000 seasons each) on the real schedule, best-ball scoring and Sleeper's 6-team bracket.

TL;DR

- **Noelle is the favorite at 25.8%** (was 19.1%). She's 1st in 8 of 12 runs and never worse than 2nd. She still leads with the record removed (23.0%), so her lead comes from roster strength, not a lucky start.
- **Raghav is 2nd at 20.6%** (was 20.1%). He's 2-0 with 50.6% bye odds, and he's 1st under ESPN and market, the sources that rate Allen and Chase highest.
- **Then a gap:** Ben 13.9% and Emma 13.7% (a tie), Henry 9.9%, Lauren 7.9%, Conrad 6.6%, Avery 1.6% (last in all 12 runs).

Standings odds

#	Manager	Rec	PF	Title %	Range	Playoff %	Bye %	Week 1 edition	Δ
1	Noelle	2-0	395.0	25.8	15–32	96.6	58.9	19.1	+6.7
2	Raghav	2-0	351.9	20.6	15–30	95.1	50.6	20.1	+0.5
3	Ben	1-1	372.8	13.9	10–21	87.3	29.6	10.3	+3.6
4	Emma	1-1	390.1	13.7	8–19	84.6	23.5	15.6	–1.9
5	Henry	0-2	334.4	9.9	6–12	69.7	11.5	13.9	–4.0
6	Lauren	2-0	400.3	7.9	6–13	78.5	17.1	11.7	–3.8
7	Conrad	0-2	301.9	6.6	3–10	58.2	7.0	7.6	–1.0
8	Avery	0-2	336.6	1.6	1–3	30.0	1.7	1.6	0.0

What changed since Week 1

- **Week 2:** Noelle beat Henry (198.9–156.6), Lauren beat Emma (186.9–158.2), Raghav beat Conrad (166.9–141.3) and Ben beat Avery (214.8–179.0). The 2-0/0-2 records are now worth about ±2.5–3 points of title odds.
- **Lauren lost Jaxson Dart for the season** (knee surgery), and Josh Jacobs is still on the exempt list. Hurts is her only QB, so Week 10 is a zero at QB.
- **Henry's pass catchers are hurt:** Reed (out to Week 12), A.J. Brown (to Week 7), Njoku (to 6), Goedert (to 5), Collins (Week 3).
- **Noelle's core is running hot:** JSN had 42.5 in Week 2 and Mahomes 26.7/35.0. Daniels (elbow, to Week 5) and Pierce (to Week 8) are out, but her roster absorbs it.
- **Ben rose the most on roster strength:** Prescott had 37.8 and Lamb 35.3 in Week 2. His one risk is Stevenson losing snaps to Henderson.
- **Emma swapped Caleb Williams (hamstring) for Tyler Shough** for 121 FAAB.

Team by team

- **Noelle (25.8%):** 2-0 on 395.0 points and ahead on paper in 11 of her 12 remaining games. Daniels (out Weeks 3–5) and Pierce are hurt, but they were her depth, not her core.
- **Raghav (20.6%):** 2-0, but the lowest scorer of the three unbeaten teams. Josh Allen (39.7, 46.8) carries a WR room that ranks 7th of 8. Week 7 vs Noelle (Allen on bye) is the danger game.
- **Ben (13.9%):** the quiet riser. The league's best best-ball converter, with a league-high 214.8 in Week 2. His Week 10 and 14 byes land in the seeding stretch.
- **Emma (13.7%):** still the deepest backfield, with the WR room still last. She gave back Week 1's windfall and swapped an injured Caleb Williams for Tyler Shough.
- **Henry (9.9%):** 0-2 and 8 of the league's 40 injury flags, but still one of the biggest point piles on paper. The injuries all fall early, and he projects as a top-three weekly scorer in Weeks 11–14.
- **Lauren (7.9%):** 2-0 with the most points (400.3), but Dart's injury leaves her one QB, so Week 10 is empty at QB and Week 13 empty at RB. The record is carrying a 7th-place roster.

- **Conrad (6.6%)**: the unluckiest 0-2 (301.9 PF, last by 32.6). Every engine rates his roster above Lauren's; the record, not the roster, drops him to 7th.
- **Avery (1.6%)**: last in all 12 runs. His QBs are now a strength, but his RB/TE starters are the league's worst, and he's the underdog on paper in all 12 remaining games.

Week 1 hot takes, re-checked

Take	Verdict
Avery has the worst squad	Still right. 8th in all 12 runs on both title odds and roster strength.
Henry is among the worst	Still wrong, but closer. He's 0-2 and banged up, yet 3rd–5th in every run and six times Avery's odds.
Conrad is much better than ranked	Not supported. 6th–7th in every run. The record costs him 3.2 points, the most in the league, so ~10% is his ceiling.

Data checks

- **D/ST scoring**: all 24 defense scores in Weeks 1–2 are non-zero and match a recount from Sleeper's raw stats. Every team score equals its best-ball optimum.
- **Caveats**: rosters are frozen from here (no waivers or trades), and Week 3 injury coin-flips are scored as out (Nacua, Aaron Jones, Collins, Darnold).